Dave MacPhee

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Results-driven Software Development and Automation Manager specializing in the evolution of traditional QA into modern, automation-first Quality Engineering capabilities. Proven track record of steering high-performing, distributed global engineering teams and consolidating fragmented legacy systems into scalable CI/CD pipelines. Currently pioneering the enterprise adoption of Agentic AI frameworks and frontier models to revolutionize automated workflows, accelerate test generation, and dramatically compress software delivery lifecycles. An approachable technical leader committed to cross-functional collaboration, team upskilling, and shared accountability for high-consequence platform reliability.

CORE EXPERTISE & TECHNICAL TOOLSET

Quality Engineering & Automation: Enterprise QE Strategy, Shift-Left Testing, Automation-First Transformation, Release Confidence Metrics, API & Integration Testing, Risk-Based Frameworks.

AI & Next-Gen Tech: Agentic AI Workflow Architecture, Model Context Protocols (MCPs), Prompt Engineering, Generative AI Integration (Claude, OpenAI, OpenCode), AI Coding Tools (Cursor, Claude Code), AI Model Evaluation, Automated Triage.

CI/CD & DevOps: Pipeline Optimization, Enterprise CI/CD Architecture (Jenkins, GitHub Actions), Tool Consolidation, Cloud-Native Applications (AWS), Global Automation Policy Design.

Strategic Leadership: Global People Management (Teams of 23+), Remote & Distributed Team Dynamics, Headcount & Vendor Strategy, Change Management, Cross-Site Collaboration.

Technical Stack: Python, Java, C/C++, Linux, AWS, SQL, REST APIs, TestRail, Jira.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SQUAD STEWARD

Austin, TX | **August 2026 – Present**

Founder

- **Company & Product:** Founded Squad Steward and built its volunteer coordination platform from concept to a working alpha in eight weeks, running an agentic engineering workflow with AI coding agents (Claude Code) and Model Context Protocols (MCPs) across design, implementation, testing, and deployment. Want a preview? Email me.

ROKU

Austin, TX | **2019 – Sept 2026**

Manager of Software Development and Automation (Progressed from Senior Engineer)

- **AI Initiatives Led:** Architected and led new Agentic initiatives driven by Model Context Protocols (MCPs) to seamlessly bridge LLMs (Claude) with enterprise development environments. Created a foundational triage AI tool in 2024 to diagnose and resolve errors, evolving this into an advanced, skills-based agent by 2026. Applied frontier models from Anthropic (Claude) and OpenAI to testing workflows to accelerate test generation, exploratory testing, and root-cause analysis.
- **Automated Weekly Rollouts:** Directed the creation of an autonomous deployment tool, built with Python, Jenkins and Docker, that verifies process readiness and executes weekly rollouts.
- **Automation-First Transformation:** Built an automation-first testing capability integrated directly into CI/CD pipelines, establishing meaningful quality gates and feedback loops spanning automated testing, production incidents, and corrective action.

- **Release Cadence & Quality:** Led the move from two-week test cycles to daily results across four product teams (Subscriptions, OS, Voice and Payments). Teams shipped on a weekly release train with fresh CI results every day, and Voice was ready to release on any day, which improved both quality and release cadence.
- **CI Pass-Rate Standard:** Set and held a 95% CI pass-rate standard across hundreds of automated tests for software running on millions of devices, so small teams could spend their time on product goals instead of triaging failures.
- **Global Team Leadership:** Scaled and led a multinational software engineering organization of 23 professionals across four product teams: Subscriptions, OS, Voice and Payments. Drove team cohesion in a fully remote environment by implementing structured virtual communication cadences, optimizing asynchronous workflows, and establishing engineering standards.

POLY (ACQUIRED BY HP) Westminster, CO | **2013 – 2019**

Manager & Architect, Software Development and Automation

- **Enterprise Tool Consolidation:** Spearheaded a global initiative to consolidate fragmented legacy testing tools into a unified enterprise CI/CD framework leveraging Python and Java, creating a scalable deployment model ideal for post-acquisition organizational growth.
- **Risk-Based Quality Frameworks:** Directed the design of robust automation solutions supporting complex, multi-product interconnected environments via Agile and DevOps principles, transitioning downstream quality checks into early risk identification.
- **Global Team Scaling:** Managed multi-country engineering teams across varying time zones to modernize release cycles, establishing clear operational frameworks to overcome distributed workflow communication challenges.

AVAYA Westminster, CO | **2000 – 2013**

Lead Software Automation Engineer & DevOps (Progressed through multiple roles)

- **QA to QE Transformation:** Championed the early adoption of DevOps strategies, demonstrating the ability to transform manual QA processes into an engineering-led capability by establishing fully automated continuous integration environments.
- **Core Systems Testing:** Designed and developed critical administration and call processing layers in C/C++; built scalable SCM and virtualization tooling infrastructure utilizing Xen, Java, PHP, and MySQL to minimize manual testing overhead.
- **Cross-Functional Partnership:** Led matrixed teams through system deliveries and complex debugging sessions, earning a Director's Award for outstanding contributions to efficiency tools and fostering shared accountability for quality.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

BSc with Honors in Software Engineering | University of Stirling (UK) | Honors Second, Upper (GPA 3.9) | Thesis: The Study of Workloads Over Networks

Professional Credentials: AWS Certified • Python Certified

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

- **Westy Brew Fest Founder & Executive Director:** Create and manage an annual community event, scaling attendance to 3,000+ people and overseeing all logistics.
- **GABF Volunteer Manager (Captain):** Direct a complex logistics workforce of over 400 personnel.
- **Youth Soccer Coach:** Voluntarily manage and coach 2 youth soccer teams.

- **Endurance Athlete:** Trained for and completed 2010 & 2013 Ironman Arizona competitions (140.6 mi).